

SENTENCE

1. Passage anchor

> “That **sentence** hit me at exactly the right time.”

Passage meaning

sentence = a group of words that expresses a complete thought, typically containing a subject and a verb

句子

Here, **that sentence** refers to Mrs. Chan's words:

> “You don't need to sound perfect; you need to sound genuine.”

Practice

1. That simple **sentence** stayed in my mind for years.

那個簡單的**句子**多年來一直留在我腦海中。

2. She wrote one **sentence** on the board and asked us to discuss it.

她在白板上寫了一個**句子**，請我們討論。

Core meanings of SENTENCE

2. sentence — a grammatical unit

= a group of words that expresses a complete idea and normally contains a subject and a finite verb

句子

Examples

1. Please write a complete **sentence**.

請寫一個完整的**句子**。

2. This **sentence** is difficult to understand.

這個**句子**很難理解。

This is the core language-learning meaning.

3. sentence — something someone says as one complete statement

In ordinary conversation, **sentence** can refer to a particular spoken utterance structured as a sentence.

一句話；一個句子

Examples

1. I couldn't understand the last **sentence** he said.
我聽不懂他剛才說的最後**一句話**。
2. Her final **sentence** completely changed the mood of the conversation.
她最後的**一句話**完全改變了談話氣氛。

This is the passage use.

Grammar-related uses

4. complete sentence

= a grammatically complete sentence rather than a fragment

完整句；完整的句子

Examples

1. Answer the question in a **complete sentence**.
請用**完整句子**回答問題。
2. "Because I was tired" is not a **complete sentence** in that context.
在那個語境中，*"Because I was tired"* 並不是一個**完整句**。

5. simple sentence

= a sentence containing one independent clause

簡單句

Examples

1. "She smiled" is a **simple sentence**.
"She smiled" 是一個**簡單句**。

2. Beginners often start by writing **simple sentences**.

初學者通常先從寫**簡單句**開始。

6. compound sentence

= a sentence containing two or more independent clauses joined together

並列句；**複合並列句**

Examples

1. "I called him, but he didn't answer" is a **compound sentence**.

"I called him, but he didn't answer" 是一個**並列句**。

2. Try combining the two ideas into one **compound sentence**.

試著把這兩個想法合併成一個**並列句**。

7. complex sentence

= a sentence containing an independent clause and at least one dependent clause

複合句

Examples

1. "I left because I was tired" is a **complex sentence**.

"I left because I was tired" 是一個**複合句**。

2. Academic writing often uses more **complex sentences**.

學術寫作通常會使用較多**複合句**。

8. sentence structure

= the grammatical organization of words and clauses within a sentence

句子結構；**句型結構**

Examples

1. Your vocabulary is strong, but your **sentence structure** needs work.

你的詞彙不錯，但**句子結構**還需要加強。

2. Varying your **sentence structure** can make writing more interesting.

改變**句型結構**可以讓文章更有變化。

9. sentence pattern

= a recurring grammatical structure used to build sentences

句型

Examples

1. Students practiced several common **sentence patterns**.
學生練習了幾種常見**句型**。
2. Once you understand the **sentence pattern**, you can create your own examples.
一旦理解這個**句型**，就可以自己造句。

10. sentence fragment

= an incomplete group of words presented as if it were a sentence

殘句；不完整句

Examples

1. "When I arrived at school" is a **sentence fragment** by itself.
When I arrived at school 單獨使用時是一個**不完整句**。
2. Check your essay for **sentence fragments**.
檢查你的文章中是否有**不完整句**。

11. run-on sentence

= two or more independent clauses incorrectly joined without suitable punctuation or conjunctions

連寫句；黏連句

Examples

1. This paragraph contains several **run-on sentences**.
這個段落有好幾個**連寫句**。
2. Use punctuation to correct the **run-on sentence**.
使用標點符號修正這個**黏連句**。

Useful for writing instruction.

Legal meaning

12. sentence — punishment imposed by a court

= an official punishment given by a court after a person has been found guilty of a crime

****判刑；刑罰；刑期****

This is a genuinely distinct major meaning.

Examples

1. The judge imposed a five-year ****sentence****.

法官判處五年****刑期****。

2. He received a prison ****sentence****.

他被判處****監禁刑****。

This has nothing to do with grammar.

13. prison sentence

= a court-ordered period of imprisonment

****徒刑；監禁刑期****

Examples

1. She received a two-year ****prison sentence****.

她被判處兩年****徒刑****。

2. The offence can carry a long ****prison sentence****.

這項罪行可能面臨很長的****監禁刑期****。

14. life sentence

= imprisonment for life, subject to the legal system involved

****無期徒刑；終身監禁****

Examples

1. He was given a **life sentence**.
他被判處**無期徒刑**。
2. The court imposed a **life sentence**.
法院判處他**終身監禁**。

The exact legal effect can differ by jurisdiction.

15. suspended sentence

= a sentence that is imposed but whose execution is delayed or avoided under certain conditions
緩刑判決；緩期執行的刑罰

Examples

1. The judge gave him a **suspended sentence**.
法官判給他**緩刑**。
2. She avoided immediate imprisonment after receiving a **suspended sentence**.
她因獲判**緩刑**而沒有立即入獄。

Legal details vary by jurisdiction, so the broad learner meaning is safest.

16. death sentence

A. legal

= a judicial sentence of death
死刑判決

B. figurative

= something likely to cause destruction, failure, or death
致命打擊；等同判死刑的事

Examples

1. The court handed down a **death sentence**.
法院作出了**死刑判決**。

2. For a small business, losing its only major customer can feel like a **death sentence**.
對小企業而言，失去唯一的大客戶可能就像**致命打擊**。

The figurative use is strong and dramatic.

Verb meaning

17. sentence someone

= officially impose a punishment on someone in court

判處；宣判

Examples

1. The judge **sentenced him to five years in prison**.

法官**判處他五年徒刑**。

2. She was **sentenced to community service**.

她被**判處社區服務**。

Very common legal verb.

18. sentence someone to + punishment

Pattern:

sentence + person + to + punishment

Examples:

* sentence someone to prison

* sentence someone to life imprisonment

* sentence someone to community service

* sentence someone to death

Practice

1. The court **sentenced him to three years in prison**.

法院**判處他三年徒刑**。

2. The defendant was **sentenced to community service**.

被告被**判處社區服務**。

19. be sentenced to something

= receive an official punishment from a court

被判處.....

Examples

1. He was **sentenced to ten years in prison**.

他被**判處十年徒刑**。

2. She was **sentenced to pay a fine**.

她被**判處罰款**。

Figurative extension of the legal sense

20. sentence someone to something unpleasant

= cause or condemn someone to experience an unpleasant condition for a long time

使某人注定遭受.....；使某人陷入.....

Examples

1. Poor planning can **sentence a project to failure**.

規劃不良可能使一個專案**注定失敗**。

2. The injury seemed to **sentence him to months of inactivity**.

那次受傷似乎使他**注定數月無法活動**。

This is metaphorical and more formal.

Useful language-learning expressions

21. make a sentence

= produce or construct a sentence

造句

Examples

1. Can you **make a sentence** using this word?

你可以用這個單字**造句**嗎？

2. Students were asked to **make sentences** with the new vocabulary.

學生被要求用新詞彙**造句**。

Very common in language classrooms.

22. write a sentence

= produce a sentence in writing

寫一句話；寫一個句子

Examples

1. **Write a sentence** describing the picture.

寫一句話描述這張圖片。

2. She wrote three **sentences** about her weekend.

她寫了三個**句子**描述週末。

23. complete a sentence

= finish an incomplete sentence

完成句子

Examples

1. **Complete the sentence** using the correct verb.

用正確的動詞**完成句子**。

2. Students had to **complete each sentence** with one word.

學生必須用一個單字**完成每個句子**。

24. rewrite a sentence

= write the same basic idea again using different wording or structure

改寫句子

Examples

1. **Rewrite the sentence** in the passive voice.

用被動語態**改寫這個句子**。

2. Try to **rewrite this sentence** more naturally.

試著把這個句子**改寫得更自然**。

Related forms

25. sentencing

= the judicial process of deciding and imposing punishment

量刑；判刑

Examples

1. The court will hold a **sentencing hearing** next month.

法院下個月將舉行**量刑聽證會**。

2. Several factors were considered during **sentencing**.

量刑時考慮了多項因素。

This is a legal derivative.

26. sentencing hearing

= a court hearing at which punishment is determined or formally imposed

量刑聽證會；判刑聽證

Examples

1. The **sentencing hearing** took place on Friday.

量刑聽證會於星期五舉行。

2. The victims spoke at the **sentencing hearing**.

受害者在**量刑聽證會**上發言。

Key contrasts

27. sentence vs phrase

****sentence****

= a complete grammatical unit

****句子****

****phrase****

= a group of words functioning together but not necessarily expressing a complete thought

****片語；詞組****

Compare:

> “in the morning”

> = a ****phrase****

> “I left in the morning.”

> = a ****sentence****

28. sentence vs clause

****clause****

= a grammatical unit containing a subject and predicate, often with a verb

****子句****

****sentence****

= a complete grammatical unit that may contain one or more clauses

****句子****

Example:

> “I stayed home because it was raining.”

This is one ****sentence**** containing two ****clauses****:

* I stayed home

* because it was raining

29. sentence vs statement

****sentence****

is primarily a grammatical concept.

****statement****

focuses on what someone declares or communicates.

Compare:

> "It is raining." is a grammatical **sentence**.

> His **statement** was that the project would continue.

A statement may consist of one sentence or several sentences.

30. sentence vs utterance

utterance

= anything spoken by a person in a particular instance

話語 ; 發話

It can be:

- * a word
- * a phrase
- * a complete sentence

So not every **utterance** is a grammatical **sentence**.

Important grammar note

31. sentence is countable

Correct:

- * a sentence
- * one sentence
- * two sentences
- * several sentences

Examples

1. Please write **three sentences**.

請寫**三個句子**。

2. That was a very long **sentence**.

那是一個很長的**句子**。

Meaning map

****sentence**** has two major modern branches that learners should keep clearly separate.

Language branch

a grammatically complete sequence of words

→ spoken or written sentence

→ sentence structure

→ simple / complex sentence

→ ****句子****

Legal branch

formal judicial judgment concerning punishment

→ prison sentence

→ life sentence

→ sentence someone to prison

→ ****刑罰；判刑；判處****

These meanings are historically connected through the idea of a formally expressed judgment, but in modern learner use they function as clearly distinct senses.

Passage recap

> “That ****sentence**** hit me at exactly the right time.”

Here:

****sentence**** = ****the particular group of words Mrs. Chan had just spoken****

Namely:

> “You don't need to sound perfect; you need to sound genuine.”

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

* ****那句話****

* ****那個句子****

In natural Chinese within this passage, ****「那句話」**** is better than the more grammatical-

sounding **「那個句子」** because the emphasis is on what Mrs. Chan said and its emotional impact.

MCQ-ready meaning

sentence in the passage

= **a group of words expressing a complete thought / something said as one complete statement**

句子；一句話

It does **not** mean the legal sense **刑期 / 判刑** here.